SAILFIN DRAGON

Hydrosaurus pustulatus

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
A small third eye senses light, sharp eyes spot fruit and movement, and it feels currents in the water.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives along rivers and mangroves in the Philippines, basking in trees right above the water.

3. How does it send messages?
Males raise a tall sail on their back, turn darker, and bob their heads to show they are boss.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When a predator gets close, it drops from a branch into the river and hides underwater.

5. How does it learn?
Hatchlings are on their own from day one and learn by practicing swimming and diving.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother digs a nest near water and lays two to eight eggs that hatch after about sixty days.

7. What are its limits?
Without a river nearby, it has no escape, and loss of bank trees takes its basking spots.

8. What does this teach us?
The river is a refuge, a travel route, and a place to hide — all in one.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Sailfin dragons live along rivers and streams in the Philippines and Indonesia.
Their riverside forests are being cleared and polluted.
They are also collected from the wild for the pet trade.

When its habitat shrinks:

- cleaner, cooler streams are harder to find
- riverbank trees they need for basking are lost
- wild populations keep shrinking across their range

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If you could run on water for a short time, when would you choose to do it?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

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